

General Lit.





About the Course

Journey into the 19th century via novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from and about the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12



Placement & Combining Tips

Some books shared with other high school grades. Literature, history, and geography lessons work in sync in Grades 9-12, so it is best to consider all three together when placing students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 2 times/week 30 min	Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass Up from Slavery James Jane Eyre The Count of Monte Cristo Short stories and other writings Things Fall Apart The Souls of Black Folk

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

Jane Eyre (Term 2: Option 1) This novel touches on difficult themes including a child in an unhappy home situation, loss, a romantic relationship with a significant secret, mental illness,

and questions of faith and duty. Teachers may wish to preview these elements before assigning.

James (Term 2: Option 2) This novel is recommended for mature students, as it includes strong language, racial slurs and stereotypes, and graphic scenes of violence and abuse, mainly directed towards the enslaved characters in the novel. These scenes intensify towards the end of the novel. Pre-reading or familiarizing yourself with the content to determine suitability for your student(s) is encouraged. Frankenstein or Silas Marner from General Lit.: Grades 9-10 are also possible alternatives.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grades 11-12



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



Up from Slavery



James



Jane Eyre



The Count of Monte Cristo

Short stories and other writings



Things Fall Apart



The Souls of Black Folk



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

∞ [Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



General Lit.: Grades 11-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ INTRO

Alexandre Dumas's *The Count of Monte Cristo* is a well-loved story of betrayal, revenge, and redemption. It was originally written as a serial, so as you read, imagine the experience of the first readers who continuously were given cliff hangers and had to wait for the next installment of the plot!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Plan to read for about 20 minutes each week and leave 10 minutes for narration and discussion. The edition chosen for this course is the abridged version, but it is still too long to cover in two terms just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time or just read 20 minutes each week, and if you are interested, you can finish the book after the end of the term.

- There are a lot of characters in this novel! Begin a character list today, and jot down a few details. What kind of a man is Edmond Dantès at the opening of the novel?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Up From Slavery

→ INTRO

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass is a classic 19th-century autobiography which details the author's story from slavery to freedom. Douglass was born enslaved in Maryland in 1818 and escaped to freedom when he was around twenty years old. He went on to have a remarkable life as a national leader of the abolitionist movement, writer, orator, and statesman.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p1-7 "I was born in Tuckahoe" - "a good overseer"

- What do we learn about Frederick Douglass's family in this opening reading?
- What initial impressions do you have of his narrative style? How might this be connected to his aims for this autobiography? Consider in particular how he describes the more difficult and violent episodes from his childhood.

→ INTRO

Today we begin reading the autobiography of Booker T. Washington. It was first written as a periodical, but was later put into book form. Washington was born a slave, but was still a child when emancipation occurred. He later founded Tuskegee Institute in Alabama, and spent his life advancing the cause of equal rights. His writings give a window into the Reconstruction period that followed the American Civil War.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.I p.1-11 "I was born" - "owners as to the future."

- How does Washington describe his childhood? How does he describe the day of emancipation?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content: Douglass's *Narrative* contains several graphic descriptions of beatings, and racial slurs.

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Term 1

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think has happened at the party?
- Describe the character of Mercédès and continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
Materials: Up From Slavery

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.7-13 "The home plantation" - "stone-like coolness."

- Reflect on Douglass's descriptions of the slave's songs. What purposes does singing serve? How has it been misunderstood?

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.11-22 "After the coming of freedom" - "or a handkerchief."

- Why were names so important to Washington and the other newly freed people?
- How does Washington describe the conditions of formerly enslaved people immediately after emancipation?
- How is education described in this chapter? Why did Washington see it as so important?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think of the character of Villefort? What is his secret?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
Materials: Up From Slavery

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-19 "His savage barbarity" - "voice of tranquil music."



Term 1

- Why do you think it is important for his narrative that Douglass describes violence in such detail? How does it strengthen his anti-slavery argument?
 - Why was leaving Colonel Lloyd's plantation such a turning point for Douglass?
-

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.22-34 "Finally, the great day came" - "get through the school year."

- What hardships does he encounter while traveling, and how does he respond to them? Where does he find the strength to persevere?
- Describe Mrs. Ruffner and how she impacted his life. Who else had an impact on Washington?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What is the political situation France as the action of the novel begins?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 8

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Up From Slavery

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-26 "But alas!" - "learning how to write."

- How did Douglass's experiences with the Aulds set him "on the pathway from slavery to freedom"? Why did Mr. Auld forbid his wife to teach Douglass to read, and what did Douglass learn from this about literacy?
 - How does Douglass teach himself to read and write? What obstacles does he face, and what does he learn about his own situation from what he reads?
-

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-6 p.34-50 "Three weeks before" - "features of the institution."

- Why does he believe education should include both academic learning and practical skills? How does Washington begin helping other members of his community?
- What opportunities and challenges arose for formerly enslaved people during the Reconstruction period? What aspects is Washington most

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Term 1

critical of?

- What does Washington learn from his experience working with Native Americans?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What is Dantès life like as a prisoner? How has he spent the years of his imprisonment so far?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 10

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
Materials: Up From Slavery

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-33 "In a very short time" - "sagacity to see it."

- What was Douglass's and the other slaves' situation when his master Captain Anthony died? How does Douglass's direct description of valuation strengthen his argument against slavery?
 - What is Douglass's life like once he lives with Thomas Auld?
-

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 p.51-64 "During the time" - "deeply as this one."

- What challenges did Washington face when he went to Tuskegee? What do we learn about his leadership style from how he faced these difficulties?
- Why does Washington praise manual labor so highly? What episodes from his younger years influenced the importance he placed on this type of work?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Which characters do you trust? Which ones are you suspicious of? Jot down some initial impressions, and it will be interesting for you to refer back to them as you get further into the novel.
- Continue to add to your character list.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 1

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 12

- Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
- Materials: Up From Slavery

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.33-39 "While I lived with my master" - "myself to my wretched lot."

- Why does Douglass call Edward Covey a "slave breaker"? What methods does Covey use to control enslaved people?
 - How does Douglass describe the physical and emotional effects of his time with Covey?
-

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10 p.64-74 "The coming of Christmas" - "or perhaps could build."

- How did the community support the school in Tuskegee?
- Why is it important for Washington to teach his students to "love work for its own sake" (72)?
- What lesson did Washington learn from brick-making about racial relations?"

★ TEACHER NOTE

Sensitive content in a quotation: Up From Slavery, p.68.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 13

- Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- How would you describe the character of Faria? What is his secret? What role does he play in Dantès life?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 14

- Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
- Materials: Up From Slavery

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-45 "I have already intimated" - "practice is a very common one."

- Why do you think Douglass describes "this battle with Mr. Covey [as] the turning point in my career as a slave"?
 - How does Douglass describe the celebration of Christmas for slaves as a tool of control rather than genuine kindness? How does this description support his anti-slavery argument?
-

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10-11 p.74-85 "The same principle" - "button is to be found missing."

- What challenges did Washington continue to face in setting up Tuskegee? How did he face them, and what can you learn from his perseverance?
- What were some lessons that Washington was trying to teach the students beyond the classroom?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 15

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- How does Dantès escape? How does he use the lessons he learned from Faria in prison to aid his plan?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 16

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: Up From Slavery

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-52 "On the first of January" - "we succeeded very well."

- How does this section show the hypocrisy between the slave-holders' professions of Christianity and their actions?
- How does Douglass describe his time with Mr. Freeland.

→ RECAP

What do you remember from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

(We are skipping chapters 12-13)

Ch.14 p.105-115 ""The Atlanta Exposition"" - ""exact justice to both races.""

- What does Washington mean by ""Cast down your bucket where you are""?
- How would you describe the overall message of his speech? How was it received?

→ LISTEN

The only audio recording of Booker T. Washington in existence is him reading the opening paragraphs of his Atlanta Exposition Speech in 1905.

∞ Audio Link: Booker T. Washington's "Atlanta Compromise" Speech

→ WATCH

This short biography of Booker T. Washington also introduces the debate

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Term 1

with W. E. B. Du Bois, which will be the focus of the next three lessons.
∞ Video Link: Booker T. Washington: Founder of Tuskegee University & Champion for Civil Rights

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 17

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What do you think Dantès will do once he is free?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 18

Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

Materials: The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-58 "After a painful waiting" - "Christian city of Baltimore."

- What is Douglass's plan to escape to freedom? What happens?
- How does Douglass's experience working at the shipyard demonstrate the injustices of the law?

→ INTRO

W.E.B. Du Bois was a prominent writer, sociologist, historian, and advocate for civil rights. He was raised in Massachusetts, and attended Fisk University, and then Harvard, where he became the first African American to receive a PhD. He devoted his life to work for full equality for African Americans.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-7 "The Forethought" & Chapter 1: Of Our Spiritual Strivings

- Compare his aims and writing style to Washington's: what are some similarities and differences?
- Du Bois introduces two significant metaphors in today's reading: his concept of the "Veil" and of "double consciousness." How would you explain them to someone?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 19

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What role does faith play in Dantès story?
- Continue to add to your character list.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 1

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 20

Lesson 20:

- Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
- Materials: The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.58-63 "Master Hugh, finding he could" - "for the reasons before mentioned."

- Why doesn't Douglass provide more details about how he escaped?
 - What does it mean for Douglass to "hire his time," and how does this practice reinforce the injustices of slavery?
-

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.18-25 Chapter 3: Of Booker T. Washington and Others

- How does Du Bois describe Washington's life and work?
- What are some of his critiques of the "Atlanta Compromise" and Washington's priorities?
- Compare the two men's views on education: what kinds of education do they each advocate?"

★ TEACHER NOTE

For more background on Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois's differing views, the following overview from Yale's Teachers Institute is helpful.

∞ **Link:** Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. DuBois: The Problem of Negro Leadership

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 21

- Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Why do you think Caderousse was Dantès first stop? What can Dantès do in disguise that he wouldn't be able to do if he revealed his true self to his former friends and acquaintances?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 22

- Materials: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass
- Materials: The Souls of Black Folk

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.52-58 "After a painful waiting" - "Christian city of Baltimore."

- What is Douglass's plan to escape to freedom? What happens?
 - How does Douglass's experience working at the shipyard demonstrate the injustices of the law?
-

→ INTRO

● EXTRA HELPING

The poet Dudley Randall wrote a poem about the debate between Washington and Du Bois.

∞ **Link:** Booker T. and W.E.B.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 1	
W.E.B. Du Bois was a prominent writer, sociologist, historian, and advocate for civil rights. He was raised in Massachusetts, and attended Fisk University, and then Harvard, where he became the first African American to receive a PhD. He devoted his life to work for full equality for African Americans. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.1-7 "The Forethought" & Chapter 1: Of Our Spiritual Strivings • Compare his aims and writing style to Washington's: what are some similarities and differences? • Du Bois introduces two significant metaphors in today's reading: his concept of the "Veil" and of "double consciousness." How would you explain them to someone?	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 23 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Count of Monte Cristo	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass OR Up from Slavery Souls of Black Folks	



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 25

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Why do you think Caderousse was Dantès first stop? What can Dantès do in disguise that he wouldn't be able to do if he revealed his true self to his former friends and acquaintances?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 26

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Orient yourself a bit more to Jane Eyre.

→ READ

p. 3 "Introduction to the Author" and p. 10 "Background of the Work"
p. 32-39 Chapter 1

Note: This book is too long to finish in the term just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time or, if you are interested, you can finish the book after the end of the term.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- The first sentence of this novel is the famous: "There was no possibility of taking a walk that day." What is evoked by this sentence? What does it assume, deny, allude to?

- View question #2 or #3 on page 263 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: JAMES)

Percival Everett described his novel James as a conversation with Mark Twain's The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn, where events from Twain's novel are reimagined from the perspective of Jim, the runaway slave. It won the Pulitzer Prize in 2025, and the committee described it as "an accomplished reconsideration of 'Huckleberry Finn' that gives agency to Jim to illustrate the absurdity of racial supremacy and provide a new take on the search for family and freedom."

Note: This book is too long to finish in the term just by reading during lesson time. Feel free to read more of the book in your free time or, if you are interested, you can finish the book after the end of the term.

→ READ P.9-20 CHAPTER 1

- What do we learn about the character of James in this opening chapter? How are his two manners of speaking connected to his identity?
- What is the first interaction like between James and Huck?

→ READ

∞ Link: Huckleberry Finn Chapter 2 opening scene

★ TEACHER NOTE

See Planning & Prep for content considerations.



Term 2

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- What do you notice reading these two scenes back to back? How does Percival Everett reimagine the scene from Huckleberry Finn? Which details does he keep and what does he change? What is the overall affect?

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 27

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What are some of the themes that you recognize in the novel so far? Does it remind you of any other books you have read?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 28

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP

How was Jane's "nature" (her personality) portrayed in chapter one and what role does it have in the plot so far?

→ INTRO (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

Keep the idea of the quest in mind in reading the novel. What is Jane's quest? What is she looking for? Is what she wants the same as what she needs?

→ READ

p. 40-63 Chapters 2 & 3

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- What is the significance of the first words of chapter 2 in terms of Jane's development of her sense of self?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What are your first impressions of the character of Jim?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p. 21-32 Chapters 2-3

- What do you learn about language in this section? How does it contribute to the irony of the novel?

→ VIEW

Understanding Everett's aims and vision for James as you begin the novel will serve as a helpful guide as you read through it.

∞ Video Link: Giving "James" a Voice: Percival Everett on his Reimagining of Huck Finn

COMPOSITION PROMPT

How does the scene in the red room reflect Gothic literature? (Elements of Gothic literature include mystery, death, the supernatural, gloom and doom, and horror.) Notice details such as the secret drawer in the wardrobe, the jewel-casket, and parchment, along with words such as spell, secret, blood, and chill. Does the scene become too unrealistic to be believable, or does Bronte succeed in making it realistic?

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 2

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 29

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- What are your thoughts on the pacing of the narrative? Remember that The Count of Monte Cristo was originally published in installments. Do you think that format dictated any elements of the narrative?
- Continue to add to your character list.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 30

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- What happened last time as Jane recovered from the red room?

→ READ

p. 64-86 Chapter 4 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #7 or #8 on page 264 and reflect orally or in writing, -----

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What stood out to you the most from the last reading? What questions do you have at this point in your reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p. 33-52 Ch.4-6

- What do you think James is helping and protecting Huck when doing so puts him in danger?
- Why is James drawn to reading Enlightenment thinkers such as Voltaire, who wrote about freedom and equality while also espousing racist views? What does his fever-dream debate with Voltaire tell us about James's views and self-education?

EXTRA HELPING: About The Brontes

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 31

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Review your character list: what early opinions about some of the characters are you beginning to change? Take some time to add to your notes about characters if you are behind.

EXTRA HELPING: The Bronte novels

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 2

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 32

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- In the last chapter, Jane is to be sent to Lowood Institution. Tell back what you remember.

→ READ

p. 86-105 Chapter 5 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #9 or #10 on page 264-265 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

Tell back what you remember about why James is on the run, and why it is so much more dangerous for him with Huck along.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.53-70 Ch.7-10

- Reread what James wrote on p.55. He has never had the opportunity to write before: why do you think these are the words he composes first?
- Why does James not agree to go across the river to Illinois?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 33

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Consider the character of Dantès/The Count. Do you recognize any of the traits he possessed at the beginning of the novel? Or did his time in prison transform him into a completely different person? Have you disapproved of any of his actions so far?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 34

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- What is Lowood Institution like so far?

→ READ

p. 105-129 Chapter 6 & 7 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 2

- View question #11 or #12 on page 264-265 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

What do you recall from your reading last week about the relationship between Huck and James?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.71-92 Ch.11-15

- Why is reading such a dangerous act? Why does James want to hide it from Huck? What realization does he have about the power of reading?
- What are some examples of irony that you have come across so far? Irony can be verbal (characters saying the opposite of what they mean), situational (the opposite of what one might expect happens), or dramatic (the reader/audience knows more than the character).

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 35

Materials: The Count of Monte Cristo

→ RECAP

Take a moment to remember where you left off in the story last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read for ~20 minutes and narrate.

- Which character are you enjoying reading about the most? Which character the least? Why?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 36

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- Tell what you remember about Jane's friendship with Helen Burns.

→ READ

- p. 130-153 Chapters 8 & 9 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #13 or #14 on page 265 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.93-113 Ch. 16-19

COMPOSITION PROMPT:

Helen's moving deathbed scene is a central moment in Jane's life, in her faith, and in her development as a character. Write about the literary, emotional, and theological significance of this scene.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 37

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 2

- What do you think will happen next in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.153-169 Chapter 10 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- What does it tell us about Jane that it takes Miss Temple's departure, rather than her own ambition, to push her toward a new life? Is she being passive, or is there something else going on?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.114-132 Ch. 20-22

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 38

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 39

 Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- Tell about Jayne's reunion with Bessie in the last chapter.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p. 169-193 Chapter 11 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #17 on page 265 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.133-148 Ch. 23-24

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 40

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 41

 Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- What happens when Jayne arrives at Thornfield Hall?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 2

- p. 193-208 Chapter 12 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- View question #18 on page 265 and reflect orally or in writing,

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.149-169 Ch.26-29

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 42

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 43

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- How did Jane meet Mr. Rochester?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p. 209-244 Chapter 13 & 14 This week is a longer reading. You can split this lesson between two days this week, read some in your free time, OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- Why do you think Brontë introduces Rochester as someone who breaks the rules of polite behavior? How does Jane's refusal to defer to him set up their relationship as something different from the typical governess-employer dynamic?

Do you find Rochester sympathetic at this point in the novel, or does something about him make you uneasy?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.170-196 Ch.30-Part 2 Ch.1

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 44

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 45

Materials: Jane Eyre OR James

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: JANE EYRE)

- What do you think will happen next in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

COMPOSITION PROMPT:

It was common in this era for women to paint and participate in other ornamental arts. How does Brontë enliven this cliché in using Jane's paintings to reveal her inner psyche and to advance the plot?

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 2

- p. 244-262 Chapter 15 OR read/listen for about 20 minutes and narrate for 10 minutes.

→ NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Write, sketch, or tell your narration briefly and then save 5-10 minutes to either answer the question(s) below or pick a few reflection questions of your own at the end of each chapter to discuss (orally or in writing).

- Jane knows her feelings for Rochester are dangerous and tries to talk herself out of them. Why does she distrust her own emotions here and is she right to?
- What do we know at this point in the story that Jane doesn't?
- What images and scenes come to mind when you think of this story? How would you describe it (so far) to someone who had never read it?

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: JAMES)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.197-217 Ch.2-5

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 46

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 47

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Count of Monte Cristo

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 48

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Jane Eyre
OR
James

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 49

"The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

We've included audio versions of these stories as an alternative to reading the written stories. Short stories can be especially fun to hear aloud with a talented narrator, though it will take longer than reading the story.

Mark Twain (1835–1910) is the pen name of Samuel Clemens, one of America's most celebrated writers who was known for his sharp wit. His most famous works include "The Adventures of Tom Sawyer" and "Adventures of Huckleberry Finn". Published in 1865, "The Celebrated Jumping Frog" was the story that made Twain a household name. The story blends exaggeration and comic timing in a way that was fresh and distinctly American when it was published. As you read, pay attention not just to what happens, but to how the story is told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.2-5 "The Celebrated Jumping Frog of Calaveras County" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What makes Simon Wheeler's way of telling his story just as funny as the story itself? Can you think of another story, movie, or TV show where the delivery matters as much as the punchline?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

The second week of this course we'll read "The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry, which is a Christmas story. Feel free to reschedule this story for closer to Christmas if desired.

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 50

Things Fall Apart Introduction

2 videos

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 51

"The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter (1862–1910), an American writer famous for his short stories about ordinary people — especially the working poor of New York City. His warm, ironic style made him one of the most popular writers of his era. Published in 1905, "The Gift of the Magi" is perhaps his most beloved story. If you have extra time, his biography (see video link) is especially interesting.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.6-9 "The Gift of the Magi" by O Henry

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Were Jim and Della's sacrifices generous or just foolish? Why?
- Where did O. Henry plant clues about the twist ending? Did any of them tip you off while you were reading?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: O. Henry bio

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 3

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 52
3-23

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 53
"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Edgar Allan Poe (1809–1849) is one of America's most distinctive and influential writers. Poe is known for dark, atmospheric tales of mystery and the macabre. Surprisingly, he also pioneered the detective story! Poe had a fascination with puzzles, codes, and the power of careful reasoning. Published in 1843, "The Gold Bug" is a mystery with a secret message written in code, and cracking it requires sharp eyes and sharp thinking. As you read, pay close attention when the cipher appears and to how the code is broken. If you'd like, see if you can work through it yourself!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.10-17 (stop at "we shall see!")

- How would you describe Legrand and Jupiter from what you've read so far?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Edgar Allan Poe bio

★ TEACHER NOTE

"The Gold Bug" contains a repeated racial slur. Please preview for your students.

If you have already read this story, you may substitute "The Old Nurse's Story" by Elizabeth Gaskell. (Also included in the PDF for this course on p.38-50.)

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 54
23-45

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 55
"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next during their adventure?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.17-23 "We crossed the creek" - "we had been digging."

- Does the narrator believe Legrand? What does he think has happened to Legrand? Do you agree?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 56
46-65

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 57
"The Gold Bug" by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What has happened so far during their adventure, especially while at the tree?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.23-29 "Around the new position" - "place of deposit."

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 3

- The narrator immediately demands an explanation rather than simply celebrating when the treasure is found. Why do you think this is?
- We are told very little about who the narrator is. What do you know so far? Why do you think we are told so little?

WEEK 5 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 58**
65-85

WEEK 6 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 59**
The Gold Bug by Edgar Allan Poe

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ RECAP

What "links" of logic has Legrand revealed so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF p.30-37

- How much of finding the treasure was logic and how much was luck, in your opinion?

• COMPOSITION

"The Gold-Bug" is considered an early template for detective fiction. What elements fit that mold? What's missing that later detective stories (such as Sherlock Holmes) add?

WEEK 6 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 60**
85-103

WEEK 7 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 61**
"The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Alexander Pushkin (1799–1837) is Russia's most celebrated and beloved writer, widely considered the father of modern Russian literature. His poetry, novels, and stories established the literary tradition that nearly every Russian writer after him would build upon. Written in 1834, "The Tale of the Golden Cockerel" is one of his narrative poems written in the style of a Russian folktale. The story reads like a fairy tale but carries the sharp edge of a fable. As you read, ask yourself who holds the real power in this story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.51-56 "The Tale of the Golden Cockrel" by Pushkin
∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- What kind of ruler is the king at the beginning of the story, and does your opinion of him change as the story progresses?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Web Link: Alexander Pushkin bio

WEEK 7 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 62**
103-122

WEEK 8 **30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 63**
"How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Leo Tolstoy (1828–1910) is best known for lengthy novels like War and Peace and Anna Karenina. But Tolstoy was also a master of the short



Term 3

story, and late in his life he turned increasingly toward simple, moral tales. Published in 1886, "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" is one of those tales. As you read, watch for how Tolstoy uses one man's desires to build suspense and make his argument.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.57-68 "How Much Land Does a Man Need?" by Leo Tolstoy

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- At the end of the story, the title's question is answered. Did the answer surprise you, or did you see it coming? Why?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 64 122-144

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 65 "The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) was a Bengali poet, writer, and philosopher from India who became the first non-European writer to win the Nobel Prize in Literature, receiving it in 1913. He was a prolific writer of poetry, short stories, novels, and plays, and is still considered one of the greatest literary figures of the modern era. His short story "The Kingdom of Cards" is written in the style of a fairy tale and uses an imaginary world to say something true about the real one.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.69-74 "The Kingdom of Cards" by Rabindranath Tagore

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Would you want to live in the Kingdom of Cards? What does your answer say about what you value?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 66 144-165

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 67 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ INTRO

Arthur Conan Doyle (1859–1930) was a British writer (born in Edinburgh, Scotland) and best known as the creator of Sherlock Holmes, arguably the most famous fictional detective in the world. He was knighted by King Edward VII in 1902. The Holmes stories defined the modern detective story and have never gone out of print. "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" is widely considered one of the finest Holmes stories ever written. As you read, pay attention to the clues Doyle plants along the way, and see how much you can figure out before he reveals the answer.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read (Or Listen): p.75-85 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Julia's mysterious dying words are "the speckled band"! Why do you

• COMPOSITION

Holmes asks Watson to come along to Stoke Moran, warning him there will be danger. Why do you think Watson agrees to come? Is Watson, loyal, brave, or does he simply trust Holmes?

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

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Term 3

think a dying clue is such a common device in detective fiction?

- Helen has been moved into her dead sister's room because of renovations and this makes Holmes suspicious. Why do you think Helen herself didn't question it more?

→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL)**

∞ Video Link: Arthur Conan Doyle bio

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 68
165-187

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 69
"The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

Materials: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Read (Or Listen): p.86-95 "The Adventure of the Speckled Band" by Arthur Conan Doyle

∞ Link: Short Stories and Folk Tales PDF

- Holmes notices what others ignore. Is that a matter of intelligence, training, habit, or something else entirely?
- Arthur Conan Doyle considered this the best of all his Sherlock Holmes stories. (You can read his top 12 at the link below.) What do you think makes it so enduring? How does it compare to Poe's "The Gold-Bug" (written almost 50 years prior) as a piece of detective fiction?

→ **VIEW (OPTIONAL)**

∞ Link: Arthur Conan Doyle's Favorite Sherlock Holmes Stories

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 70
187-209

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 71
Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 72

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

Examination

Term 1

· Describe Edmond Dantès relationship with Faria; in what ways are they father and son, as Faria claims (72)? How does Faria equip Dantès for his life after prison? OR

Write a character sketch of Dantès at the very beginning of the novel, before he is arrested.

· (Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass): Explain why reading and literacy were such an important first step in Douglass's path from slavery to freedom. OR Describe some of the ways Douglass's Narrative is such a powerful argument against slavery.

(Up from Slavery & Souls of Black Folk): Describe Washington's and Du Bois's differing views on the purpose of education. OR

Tell all you know about Washington's early life and how it impacted his future leadership at the Tuskegee school.

Term 2

· Jane Eyre: What are some ways in which Bronte builds mystery and suspense in the first volume? OR What is the basis of the mutual attraction between Jane and Mr. Rochester? Does their attraction seem realistic or romantic? Or both?